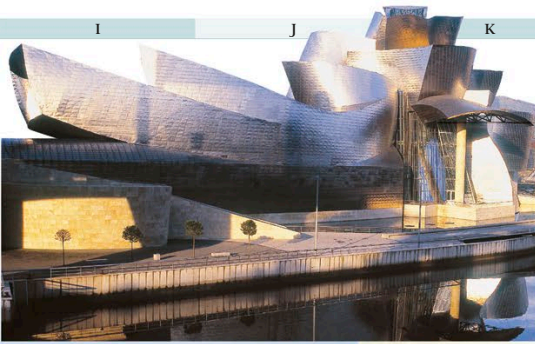




SPANISH CITIES

The majority of Spanish people live in towns and cities. Madrid is the largest Spanish city and the capital of Spain. Tourists flock to Barcelona, capital of Catalonia and a leading cultural, economic, and industrial hub. Bilbao, home to the magnificent Guggenheim Museum, is the capital of the Basque region and a busy port.

The Guggenheim, a modern art museum in Bilbao



The Pamplona bull run is an annual fiesta that takes place in July.

FIESTAS

In Spain, many towns hold their own fiestas, or festivals, to celebrate a special event in their history or the birthday of their patron saint. These fiestas differ from one region to another. One of the most famous is held in Pamplona, where the brave run with the bulls.



HOLY WEEK

Easter in Spain is marked by solemn celebrations, known as the Holy Week processions. These processions vary according to the region, but generally, men wear robes and hoods and carry heavy crosses to show penitence.

Flamenco dancing was created by the gitanos (Romani people) of Andalusia and dates back to the 15th century.

REGIONAL SPAIN

There are 17 Spanish regions, each with its own distinct cultures and traditions. For example, in the south is Andalucía, with flamenco dancing and traces of Moorish influences.

COASTAL RESORTS

Every year, millions of northern Europeans head south for the beaches of southern Spain and Portugal, or for the Spanish Balearic Islands. They are attracted by the warm climate as well as affordable hotels and restaurants.

